

Assignment-final-project

Final Project: AI Policy Brief

Overview

Create a professional policy brief addressing an AI-related issue of your choice. This capstone project synthesizes course material and presents your analysis to policymakers or institutional stakeholders.

Assignment Details

Due Date: Finals week

Format: 2,500-3,500 words + 1-2 page executive summary

Submission: Word document or PDF + optional 5-min video presentation

Submission: D2L Brightspace

What is a Policy Brief?

A policy brief is a concise, evidence-based document that: - Identifies a specific problem - Reviews current policy/state of the field - Proposes actionable solutions - Addresses likely counterarguments - Is written for decision-makers

Audience: Policy officials, institutional leaders, or corporate governance bodies

Project Steps

Step 1: Choose a Topic (Due by Week 12)

Select an AI policy issue that interests you:

Examples: - AI transparency requirements for algorithms - Regulating facial recognition in law enforcement - Data privacy legislation (model after GDPR/CCPA) - AI bias auditing and certification - Autonomous vehicle liability frameworks - Content moderation governance - AI in hiring discrimination prevention - Intellectual property and generative AI - Algorithmic accountability and due process - AI environmental impact regulation

Your topic should: - Be narrow and specific (not “AI policy in general”) - Have recent developments or open debates - Be feasible to research in available

time - Interest you personally

Step 2: Research (Weeks 12-14)

Gather evidence from: - Policy papers and white papers - Academic research - News coverage and case studies - Expert opinions and interviews (if possible) - Comparable policies from other jurisdictions - Industry responses

Minimum sources: 15 credible sources

Step 3: Structure Your Brief

I. Executive Summary (1-2 pages)

- Problem statement
- Proposed solution
- Key benefits and costs
- Call to action

II. Problem Definition (400-500 words)

- What is the issue?
- Why does it matter?
- Who is affected?
- What are current gaps or failures?
- Evidence of the problem

III. Policy Context (400-500 words)

- Current relevant policies/regulations
- International comparisons
- What has been tried and how well it worked
- Why existing approaches are insufficient
- Key stakeholders

IV. Proposed Solution (700-1000 words)

- Specific policy recommendation(s)
- How it addresses the problem
- Implementation timeline
- Required resources
- Success metrics
- How it differs from alternatives

V. Analysis & Tradeoffs (500-700 words)

- Benefits of your proposal
- Potential costs/challenges
- Who wins and who loses

- Feasibility assessment
- Potential unintended consequences

VI. Counterarguments & Responses (400-500 words)

- Likely objections from stakeholders
- Your response to each objection
- Why your solution is still preferable
- Compromise possibilities

VII. Conclusion & Next Steps (200-300 words)

- Restate the urgency
- Call to action
- Implementation roadmap

Rubric (100 points)

Criteria	Excellent (20)	Good (16-19)	Satisfactory (12-15)	Needs Work (0-11)
Problem Definition	Clear, well-evidenced, compelling	Well-articulated, with evidence	Problem identified; some evidence	Unclear or unsupported
Research Quality	Comprehensive, authoritative sources	Good mix of sources	Adequate sources	Few or weak sources
Policy Knowledge	Sophisticated understanding of context	Good grasp of existing policies	Basic policy awareness	Limited policy knowledge
Solution Design	Creative, feasible, well-justified	Sound proposal with implementation plan	Reasonable solution	Unclear or unrealistic

Criteria	Excellent (20)	Good (16-19)	Satisfactory (12-15)	Needs Work (0-11)
Analysis Depth	Nuanced exploration of trade-offs	Good analysis of pros/cons	Basic analysis present	Superficial treatment
Counterargument Engagement	Thoughtful convincing responses	Good acknowledgment of objections	Some objections addressed	Weak or missing
Writing Quality	Excellent clarity; professional tone	Well-written; mostly professional	Generally clear; minor issues	Unclear or unprofessional
Citations & Sources	Impeccable APA citations	Correct citations throughout	Most citations correct	Missing or improper citations
Feasibility	Realistic and actionable	Mostly feasible	Some feasibility concerns	Unrealistic
Originality	Novel angle or synthesis	Fresh perspective	Competent treatment	Derivative

Presentation Option

Instead of or in addition to the written brief, you may submit a 5-minute video presentation:

- Deliver key arguments from brief
- Use visuals (slides, diagrams, charts)
- Address camera directly; professional presentation style
- Submit video link (YouTube, Vimeo, institution's media server)

Video Rubric: Clarity, organization, persuasiveness, production quality

Resources

Policy Brief Examples

- Brookings Institution - Think tank policy briefs
- American Enterprise Institute - Policy papers and briefs
- Carnegie Endowment - International policy briefs

AI Policy Resources

- AI Policy Institute
- Center for Security and Emerging Technology (CSET)
- Partnership on AI Policy Recommendations
- Stanford Internet Observatory

Writing Guides

- Writing Policy Briefs - MIT guide
- Policy Brief Template - UN template

Tips for Success

1. **Start with passionate curiosity** - Choose an issue you genuinely want to understand
2. **Read actual policy** - Don't just summarize what others say
3. **Think like a policymaker** - Consider implementation, politics, feasibility
4. **Use specific evidence** - Examples and data beat generalizations
5. **Acknowledge complexity** - Real policy has tradeoffs; don't oversimplify
6. **Make it actionable** - Give specific next steps, not abstract ideals
7. **Get feedback early** - Share draft with classmates or instructor

Accessibility Accommodations

- Extended deadline available
- Can submit as audio essay or detailed outline + presentation
- Can work in pairs
- Instructor can help brainstorm or review drafts
- Alternative formats accepted (video only, infographic + summary, etc.)

Grading Timeline

- **Week 14:** Instructor meets with students to review topic and outline
- **Finals week:** Submissions due
- **3 weeks after:** Grades returned with detailed feedback

Questions? Post in forum or email your instructor.

This is your chance to have a real impact on policy conversations around AI!